



Dynamic duo: Sai Sudharsan and Shubman Gill have combined to give Gujarat Titans a measured, high-control PowerPlay. PTI

headspace and be expressive and natural when I step onto the ground.”

Sai Sudharsan also admits that he has toned down his routines, sticking only to pragmatic ones.

“I used to have a lot of superstitions, but over time I have reduced them and made everything more practical and logical. Sometimes I would eat the same food — it could be ice cream or biryani. If the game went well, I would repeat it for 14 games. I have done that before, but now I have taken it out of my system. It’s just an example,” he says.

The left-hander was last in action in national colours against South Africa in a home Test series, where India suffered a 2-0 defeat.

Sai Sudharsan featured only in the second Test in Guwahati and

SAI SUDHARSAN'S FAITH IN HIS NATURAL STYLE HAS BROUGHT RICH REWARDS, MOST NOTABLY THE ORANGE CAP IN IPL 2025, WHEN HE ACCUMULATED 759 RUNS AT AN IMPRESSIVE STRIKE RATE OF 156.17

known for his quirky preparation routines. During the England Test series in 2025, he was spotted jotting in his journal before walking out to bat and engaging in visualisation exercises. This is in addition to his habit of not batting on the eve of a game and assessing the pitch by walking on it barefoot.

It would be easy to label these as superstitions and dismiss them. But

in a high-pressure environment like competitive sport, such forms of pattern-building are essential for performance, he believes.

“Most sportsmen do it. It’s a feel-good thing. Whatever you do, even practice, it’s about making you feel good and confident. So, whatever helps us feel that way is good. There is a reason for me to do these things — to be in a good

managed just 29 runs across both innings. It was a failure that prompted serious introspection.

“I had so much anger towards myself that I was not able to execute when the team needed it. But once the series finished, I understood that I need to work more, be better prepared, and be ready when the situation comes again. That was the biggest thing on my mind.”